

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Pentecost 10
Another Kind of Freedom ~ Kin-dom Economics
9 August 2026

COMMUNION

Preaching: ML

Worship Leading: Cynthia Siadat & LVF

Dr. Jaebon Hwang- guest organist

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Jaebon Hwang, *Guest Organist*

Chiming of the Hour

[LVF & Cynthia center chancel]

Welcome

LVF

Words of Gathering

CS & LVF

May it be so.

May it be so for all of us!

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn Of Gathering**

[Laura center chancel]

Prayer of Awareness

LVF

[All turn towards choir]

Introit

[Cynthia to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

CS

Let us pray together this Lord's Prayer, adapted by enfleshed...

*Creator of us all,
who dwells within and beyond,
Sacred is your name.
May your holy vision for collective flourishing
come to fruition among us.
May your dreams of justice, love, compassion, and
connection be enfleshed on earth.
Provide us today with what we need to be nourished
in body, soul, and heart.
Forgive us for the harm we cause as we seek to
forgive those who have harmed us.
Lead us away from everything that destroys and
liberate us from the hands of evil.
For you are the ultimate source of hope.
Your power-with exceeds all power-over.
Your presence incites eternal wonder.
All praise to you, our comfort and our strength.
Amen and Amen!*

[enfleshed/adpt/lvf]

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Laura center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

LVF

Please join me in these words of peace:

And also with you.

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

[Cynthia to lectern]

Reading from Our Religious Tradition

from the Book of Acts

CS

All who believed were together and had all things in common; they would sell their possessions and goods and distribute the proceeds to all, as any had need. Day by day, as they spent much time together in the temple, they broke bread at home and ate their food with glad and generous hearts, praising God and having the goodwill of all the people.

For the witness and challenge of our ancestors...

Thanks be to God!

[Christoph transition Laura to center chancel]

Prayers with the People

LVF

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

[2 minutes Christoph transition out of silence]

Prayer of Our Hearts

Holy One, you are always and forever with us. You have offered us, and our ancestors before us, your life-giving presence - but we don't always respond to your invitations. The abundance of your world overwhelms us; your faithfulness surrounds us, and yet...we draw back.

You have shown us through Jesus, the humanity you hope can be ours. It all sounds so good God – freedom, justice, peace – but these things ask so much of us! And because we forget to rely on the help you offer through the Spirit of Life, we grow discouraged or indifferent...too easily. And yet, O God, we do want what you want – a new creation where we shall live, one and all, as one people.

On this day, Holy One, let this kind of newness begin with us – help us to forget what lies behind and turn our hearts and hands to what is ahead. Help us get free from the chains of guilt and self-pity, which stop our energy to love and our ability to *be* loved. Freshen up our hopes and dreams and help us make a new commitment to what lies before us.

And then, O God, bring us to a place, where we can help each other as we share in the mystery of life - and as we share the goodness of you.

This we pray, creating with you, transforming God!

Amen and Amen.

[Christoph transition for choir]

Meditation Anthem

[Christoph transition Michael to pulpit]

Sermon

Kin-dom Economics

ML

[Christoph transition as Michael & Laura go behind communion table]

The Eucharist and Blessings

LVF & ML

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

We give thanks to God for our life

And the courage we are given to live it.

Let our gratitude for life be expressed in our generosity.

Let our faith be expressed in good causes.

Let our belief in the future find full expression

In our daily attitude of mind. [Frances McNab]

We give thanks for the invitation to be at this table,

For here we are shown our lives...

The daily bread of work and care,

The cup of delight, pressed from the fruits of creativity

And our brokenness, with all its pain and self-knowledge.

We celebrate that life is ours

For we know we are precious in your sight.

We celebrate the life that is yours, pattern of reality for us:

Life that is love revealed

Love given and received

Love in action.

Therefore with all your lovers through the ages

We praise you, saying:

Heaven and earth are full of your glory.

Blessed are those who come in the name of

Love and Hope.

Bread and Fruit of the Vine

We give thanks for the Spirit of New Life

Active in our lives

As it was in the life of Jesus.

At this gathering in this sacred place

We take bread as Jesus took bread,

And we remember as Jesus remembered,

The constant presence

Of the Spirit of Life and Love.

We break and share this bread

As Jesus broke and shared it.

We share this bread as our pledge of openness
To the Spirit in our midst,
And in acknowledgement
Of our eternal connectedness with the Spirit of Life.

We take this fruit of the vine and pour it as Jesus poured it.

We drink as Jesus invited the friends to drink,
Mindful of the relationship of love and trust
Between ourselves and the Spirit of Life,
Believing as Jesus believed,
That beyond pain and shadows and death,
Life in the Spirit continues
In ways beyond our imagining.

LVF: This table is for all, whether you have a lot of faith, etc....

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

[Cynthia to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

CS

Offertory

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Cynthia to lectern]

***Prayer of Offering**

Holy One, through the offering of these gifts

CS

may we become a more open people.
Help us to be more open-minded in listening for your Word and wisdom,
open-hearted in working to heal a broken world,
open-handed in giving to those in need.

*With thanks for all good gifts, we present a portion of our substance
and the whole of ourselves.*

*We offer this prayer with hope for the freedom of all.
Amen and Amen!*

Please be seated

[Michael & Laura center chancel]

Life at First Church

ML & LVF

Words of Blessing

ML

For freedom,
the Holy One has set us free!
No longer bound by fear;
Not tempted towards
destruction!
Love is our salvation and
justice is our cause.
With the Spirit as our guide,
We shall not be moved.
-enfleshed

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!

Choral Response

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Laura center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Jaebon Hwang, *Guest Organist*

Inside The Music